CELPIP EXPRESS

Listening Test

STUDY MATERIALS - 12

PART 1

Listening to Problem Solving

Question 1 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question

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Question 2 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question.

- It is practical.
- It is a new product.
- It is uncommon.
- It is easy to use.

Question 3 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question.

- She dislikes online ordering.
- She lost her membership card.
- She misunderstood a store policy.
- She wants to avoid extra fees.

Question 4 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question.

- $20
- $40
- $50
- $60

Question 5 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question.

- He disagrees with the store policy.
- He knows she is a regular customer.
- He understands the woman's situtation.
- He gets a commission on her purchase.

Question 6 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question.

- She has ordered the hat she wants.
- The man found the hat in the store.
- She is going to renew her daughter's membership.
- The man is offering an extra discount on her purchase.

Question 7 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question.

- defensive
- suspicious
- hesitant
- discouraged

Question 8 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question

- She does not like shopping online.
- She has just cancelled her store membership.
- She does not like playing sports.
- She has bought items from this store before.

PART 2

Listening to a Daily Life Conversation

Question 1 of 5: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ neighbours
- ◯ colleagues
- ◯ volunteers
- ◯ strangers

Question 2 of 5: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ at the bus stop
- ◯ in an ambulance
- ◯ at the library
- ◯ at the hospital

Question 3 of 5: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ at the library
- ◯ in a first aid class
- ◯ in bookkeeping
- ◯ with cancer patients

Question 4 of 5: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ He has a special business skill.
- ◯ He likes helping children.
- ◯ He works well with people.
- ◯ He is a trained paramedic.

Question 5 of 5: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ She will recommend him as a volunteer.
- ◯ She knows places in need of bookkeepers.
- ◯ She is an expert on volunteering.
- ◯ She already volunteers at the hospital.

PART 3

Listening for Information

Question 1 of 6: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ a security officer
- ◯ an orientation guide
- ◯ a personal assistant
- ◯ a fellow newcomer

Question 2 of 6: Choose the best answer

- ◯ The man was hired as a temporary employee.
- ◯ This is the man's first day on the job.
- ◯ This is a new field of work for the man.
- ◯ The man will work in the Info Tech department.

Question 3 of 6: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ later that day
- ◯ in a couple days
- ◯ early next week
- ◯ tomorrow morning

Question 4 of 6: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ Marie will show him where to find them.
- ◯ Employees must pass a test before using them.
- ◯ He is expected to teach himself how to use them.
- ◯ They sound like difficult programs to learn.

Question 5 of 6: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ carefully consider his decisions
- ◯ opt out of the company's plan
- ◯ skip the meeting about benefits
- ◯ reschedule his benefits meeting

Question 6 of 6: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ She has eaten pretzels from the cart.
- ◯ She goes to the cafeteria for lunch.
- ◯ She does not have snacks for break.
- ◯ She has arranged the cart's schedule.

PART 4

Listening to a News Item

1. The news item is mainly about a _____
- ◯ predictable problem.
- ◯ major change.
- ◯ new controversy.
- ◯ failed endeavor.

2. According to the Program Director, the increase in programs is due to _____
- ◯ both supply and demand.
- ◯ a government mandate.
- ◯ the closure of a nearby college.
- ◯ competition from local businesses.

3. The new courses will mostly be _____
- ◯ focused on one subject.
- ◯ longer in duration.
- ◯ aimed at working people.
- ◯ paid for by employers.

4. Buffer suggests that contract work has _____
- ◯ increased recently in their area.
- ◯ impacted benefits for their staff.
- ◯ influenced their hiring process.
- ◯ improved their student enrollment.

5. The new sessions will be held at _____
- ◯ the main campus.
- ◯ one of the satellite campuses.
- ◯ various locations.
- ◯ the Chamber of Commerce.

PART 5

Listening to a Discussion

1. What is the conversation mainly about?
- ◯ the way people spend their vacations
- ◯ a modification in the vacation rules
- ◯ a decrease in the number of vacation days
- ◯ the man's violation of the vacation policy

2. Under what condition does Trish threaten to sue the company?
- ◯ if it decreases her vacation time
- ◯ if it denies her scheduled vacation
- ◯ if it refuses to pay for her vacation time
- ◯ if it insists she vacation 1 week at a time

3. What is likely true of Trish?
- ◯ She does not travel very far for her vacations.
- ◯ She is hesitant to complain about the company.
- ◯ She takes all of her vacation time at once.
- ◯ She has not worked for the company very long.

4. What does Glenda usually use her time off for?
- ◯ family holidays
- ◯ extended weekends
- ◯ personal errands
- ◯ parental duties

5. How does Mark feel?
- ◯ uncertain about the information he shared
- ◯ happy with the Human Resources department
- ◯ angry about the rumours he has heard
- ◯ supportive of filing a formal complaint

6. How does Mark respond to the possible change?
- ◯ He wants to improve it.
- ◯ He thinks about quitting.
- ◯ He refuses to consider it.
- ◯ He tries to understand.

PART 5

7. What do the two woman decide to do?

- write a letter of complaint
- investigate the matter
- escalate their grievance
- contact their union officier

8. What is Trish's attitude toward parents needing days off?

- receptive
- unsympathetic
- disgusted
- accommodating

PART 6

Listening for Viewpoints

1. The purpose of this talk is to _____

- propose changes to a trade agreement.
- discuss the trade of wine and beer in Canada.
- describe changes to interprovincial trade.
- explain trade between the USA and Canada.

2. The speaker states that 40% of Canadian trade _____

- is to the United States.
- is highly regulated.
- is between large companies.
- is between provinces.

3. Current restrictions on wine and beer sales exist because _____

- Canadians think the sale of alcohol should be regulated.
- historical laws are hard to change.
- wine and beer sales are increasing.
- provincial politicans are unable to change the law.

4. Terry Witten would probably agree that _____

- the new agreement will restrict workers.
- the old regulations had less red tape.
- non-local businesses should be penalized.
- the new agreement is an improvement.

5. The new agreement has a long list of _____

- product exceptions.
- product recommendations.
- approved trade items.
- required trade items.

6. According to Sandy Ford, the new agreement _____

- includes fewer policies and procedures.
- promotes a more liberal change.
- is an entirely positive one for provinces.
- has added unnecessary measures.

Answer Key

PART 1	
Question 1	
Question 2	It is practical.
Question 3	She wants to avoid extra fees.
Question 4	$40
Question 5	He understands the woman's situtation.
Question 6	She has ordered the hat she wants.
Question 7	hesitant
Question 8	She has bought items from this store before.

PART 2	
Question 1	colleagues
Question 2	at the bus stop
Question 3	at the library
Question 4	He works well with people.
Question 5	She will recommend him as a volunteer.

PART 3	
Question 1	an orientation guide
Question 2	This is the man's first day on the job.
Question 3	later that day
Question 4	He is expected to teach himself how to use them.
Question 5	carefully consider his decisions
Question 6	She has eaten pretzels from the cart.

PART 4	
Question 1	major change.
Question 2	both supply and demand.
Question 3	aimed at working people.
Question 4	increased recently in their area.
Question 5	various locations.

PART 5	
Question 1	a modification in the vacation rules
Question 2	if it decreases her vacation time
Question 3	She takes all of her vacation time at once.
Question 4	parental duties
Question 5	uncertain about the information he shared
Question 6	He tries to understand.
Question 7	escalate their grievance
Question 8	unsympathetic

PART 6	
Question 1	describe changes to interprovincial trade.
Question 2	is between provinces.
Question 3	historical laws are hard to change.
Question 4	the new agreement is an improvement.
Question 5	product exceptions.
Question 6	has added unnecessary measures.

Transcripts

Listening to Problem Solving

You are about to hear a conversation between a man and a woman at a store. The man is a salesperson and the woman is a customer.

Section 1:

MAN: Can I help you find anything?

WOMAN: Yes. I'm looking for a Norgus. I just tried the outdoor supply store next door, but they're sold out.

MAN: Hmm. I'm not familiar with Norgus. Is that a type of tent?

WOMAN: No, but you can use it while camping! You wear it on your head and it's got this wide brim to prevent sunburn. There's a zippered pocket inside for your credit cards. And, in a boating emergency, you can inflate it and use it as a flotation device.

MAN: Ohhhh, I've heard of those! They're those ones with the net you that you can pull down over your face to keep the bugs away. Let me just check my computer . . . No, sorry, we don't have them in the store, but you can order one online.

WOMAN: Your store online?

MAN: Yes, we have a wider selection of clothing online. This store is so small; we mainly carry sports equipment.

WOMAN: Okay, thanks!

Now answer questions 1-2.

1. What is the woman looking for?
2. What does the woman say about the product she wants?

Section 2:

MAN: Any luck with the Norgus hat?

WOMAN: Sort of . . . I started to order one, but I stopped before paying. Your store's website charges $40 for the hat—which is a good deal!—but then they want $20 for shipping.

MAN: Well, you can get free shipping if you join our customer club.

WOMAN: Yeah, I saw that . . . But it costs $50 a year to join, so it's really not worth it for me. I don't think I would use it that often.

MAN: Yeah, I see your point. What I would do is join the customer club, then buy your hat online and get the free shipping. There's a 30-day free trial period, so after three weeks, you could cancel your membership. You won't be charged—unless you wait too long.

WOMAN: I like that idea.

MAN: Yeah, why pay for a full-year membership if you only need it once?

WOMAN: Right. You know, I can order it right here from my phone . . .

Now answer questions 3-5.

3. What problem does the woman have now?
4. How much does the store charge for a Norgus hat?
5. Why does the man want to help the woman?

Transcripts

Section 3:

MAN: Success?

WOMAN: Yes! I just placed my order. And I texted my daughter about the free shipping.

MAN: Oh, great! Is she familiar with our store's website?

WOMAN: Oh yeah! She texted me back saying that she used to have a membership, but it's expired. She found a tennis racquet on the site that she wants me to order for her.

MAN: Well, why not? You get free shipping for now.

WOMAN: Yeah . . . but my daughter lives far away. Will the store ship my order to her for free?

MAN: Sure. Use your address for billing, and enter her address for shipping. It will still be free.

WOMAN: Great! My daughter will be thrilled!

Now answer questions 6-8.

6. Why is the woman happy?
7. How does the woman initially feel about shipping to her daughter?
8. What seems true about the woman's daughter?

Transcripts

Listening to a Daily Life Conversation

You will hear a presentation between a man and a woman about volunteering.

MAN: Hi Shirin. Has the #8 bus gone by yet?

WOMAN: Hi Farhod. Not yet. It's always late. Did you finish everything you needed to do at the office?

MAN: Yeah, I did at last. It took me most of the afternoon, though, so I missed the staff meeting. What did they talk about?

WOMAN: It was interesting for a change. There was a presentation on the importance of volunteering in the community. The speaker gave us a list of websites to check, and she mentioned a few organizations that are looking for volunteers. You know, I bet a lot of places are looking for a volunteer bookkeeper. You would be in demand!

MAN: Maybe, but I think if I spend my time volunteering, I'd prefer to do something where I help people. You know what I mean? Something meaningful and rewarding. Bookkeeping doesn't use my people skills! My dream was to be a paramedic, but I don't think there are volunteer opportunities on an ambulance.

WOMAN: The speaker said the hospital is looking for volunteer greeters, especially in the kids' cancer center. I guess they welcome patients and caregivers, give them directions, and help keep the children busy. You'd be great doing that!

MAN: Hmmm, I don't know. That could be stressful. I don't have any training for helping sick people. Our kids are almost never sick! Did the speaker mention anything about volunteering at the library? I can see me doing that. I'm kind of a quiet, reserved guy anyway.

WOMAN: You underestimate yourself! You're always very friendly, cheerful, and helpful at work, and you're always willing to take that extra step to help someone. I think volunteering at the hospital would be perfect for you, as it would require people skills. You'd certainly get that good feeling of helping people!

MAN: Wow, that's wonderful praise! Maybe you'd write a reference letter for me, then?

WOMAN: Sure! First thing tomorrow morning while you fill out the online volunteer application for the hospital. Oh, here comes the #8. Right on time for a change.

Now answer questions 1-5.

1. What is the relationship between the man and woman?
2. Where are the man and woman?
3. Where does the man think he would enjoy volunteering?
4. Why would the man be an excellent hospital volunteer?
5. Why might the man take the woman's advice?

Transcripts

Listening for Information

You will hear a conversation between two office employees, a man and a woman.

MAN: Hello, Ms. Green? I'm Robert. I've been told to report to you.

WOMAN: Oh hello, Robert. Yes, please, this way. This will be your workstation. Someone from Info Tech will be up later this morning to get you set up with your computer password and make sure that you can access all our basic programs.

MAN: Do you use Windows? Microsoft Office? I'm quite familiar with that operating system and those programs.

WOMAN: Yes, we do. There are also two other specialized programs you'll be using, but Info Tech will show you how to access the self-study tutorials. In a couple days, I'll check with you to see if you have any problems.

MAN: Thanks. I shouldn't have any issues, though. I've done this type of work before.

WOMAN: That's good to hear! Our supplies closet is at the end of the hall. Marie should have equipped your desk with everything you need, but if there is something missing, please go help yourself. Do remember to sign the sheet for everything you take.

MAN: Okay. If there's something I need that isn't in the closet, should I ask Marie?

WOMAN: Yes. If it's not something she can provide, come see me. We may need to make a special request, though I can't imagine you'll need anything other than our usual supplies.

MAN: Got it. I doubt I'll be needing anything else either.

WOMAN: You're scheduled to see someone in Human Resources later this afternoon. She'll walk you through all the paperwork to get you set up, direct deposit for payroll, as well as our various benefits. Most people find the information overwhelming, so feel free to take it home with you. You'll want to think about the various options with respect to medical and pension.

MAN: I didn't have any benefits at my last job, so I think I may indeed be overwhelmed. Thank you for your advice.

WOMAN: Lastly, we stagger our lunch hours so our department is always staffed. Are you okay with 12:30?

MAN: Yes, that'll be fine. The lunch break is 45 minutes?

WOMAN: Yes. There's a cafeteria on site, but for your breaks, if you want a snack, there's a snack cart that comes around. You'll know when it's here—people rush out of their seats to get the good stuff! My personal favourite are their soft pretzels!

Now answer questions 1-6.

1. What best describes the woman's role?
2. What does the conversation imply?
3. When will Info Tech see the man?
4. What is true of the specialized computer programs
5. What will the man likely do about benefits?
6. What is likely true about the woman?

Transcripts

Listening to a News Item

You will hear a news item about an education issue.

This fall, Cooper College will offer significantly more continuing education opportunities. According to Program Director Amy Buffer, the increase is due to the almost doubling of the city's population over the last five years. Not only are there far more qualified people to offer continuing education programs, she says, but there is an increased desire for them. The College will also introduce a new delivery format. Traditionally, programs were either full or half courses, lasting eight or four months, or they were week-long seminars. The College has plans, however, for more than sixty single-day sessions dedicated to diverse, but specific subject matters. Most professionals, Buffer says, neither need nor can afford an entire week of study. She mentions that while employers used to pay for such courses, the prevalence of contract employment has unfortunately meant the end of such employer-provided benefits. The sessions will be held not at the main campus or even one of its two satellite campuses. Instead, Buffer says, locations will be determined by the sessions themselves. For example, the digital photography session will be held at a local studio, and the business start-up session will be held at the local Chamber of Commerce.

Transcripts

Listening to a Discussion

You will watch a discussion among three people. They are colleagues at work. They are having a conversation in the lunch room.

Mark: Hey, have you two heard that they're thinking of changing our vacation policy?

Glenda: Changing it how? I hope they're not thinking of reducing the number of days we get!

Trish: They'd better not be thinking that! I've worked here a long time in order to earn my three weeks' vacation every year. I'll sue if they suddenly say I can only have two weeks!

Mark: No, I don't think they're changing the total number of days that we're entitled to. I believe they're considering changing how many we can take at one time.

Trish: You mean I can't take all my weeks at the same time? But one week isn't long enough to go anywhere! Two weeks is barely long enough!

Mark: No, what they're saying—or, at least, what I believe they're saying—is you can't just take a day here and a day there. You know how Phil takes all of his vacation days on Fridays? So he has three-day weekends all summer long?

Glenda: This new rule applies to any single days? But I often take my vacation days for when my kids are sick.

Mark: Well . . . I think what they're saying is you have to take your vacation in minimum 5-day chunks—whole weeks. I sort of see what they're saying. It's a lot harder to cover one day than it is to hire a temp for a week or two.

Glenda: You're right—a temp for a day doesn't help much. Still, I think we should be able to take our vacation days however we want.

Trish: I totally agree. Too bad we don't have a union. Do either of you want to come down to Human Resources with me to make a complaint?

Mark: No, don't do that! I mean, at least confirm the change in policy first. At this point, it's all just hearsay, rumours . . .

Glenda: I'll come with you. I need those individual days for when my kids are sick!

Trish: I'm not sure your point is relevant. We're all entitled to days off. What you do on those days shouldn't be considered any more important than anyone else's choices.

Glenda: I agree, in theory. But—you don't have kids, do you? . . .

Transcripts

Listening for Viewpoints

You will hear a presentation about free trade.

Have you heard this crazy thing about free trade in Canada? It is actually easier for a winery in California to send a case of wine into Alberta than for a BC winery to do the same—all because of the existing trade agreement between the provinces, which has been in effect since 1995.

Despite the fact that 40% of Canada's exports are actually to other provinces, the regulatory environment on trade is completely restrictive. And it's not just wine and beer that have been affected. Everything from refrigerators to artisanal cheese has had barriers to their trade, from outright restrictions to enormous amounts of red tape.

In the previous trade agreement, the provinces had to list all of the trade items that were to be allowed to pass freely over the borders, and it was inevitable that some items were left off the list. Wine and beer, for example, have been left off the list since 1928, when a law was enacted that allowed provincial governments to control alcohol sales across their borders. Slow-moving change makes it understandable why these details have never come off the books.

On July 1, 2017, Canada's 150th birthday, the Canadian Free Trade Agreement, or CFTA, was brought into effect. It uses a "negative list" approach. Essentially, jurisdictions will lift all barriers to trade, but must now list specific exceptions.

Terry Witten, a prominent trade lawyer, says, "The solution is a modern and ambitious agreement, and one that will primarily reduce regulatory barriers. It promises to reduce or eliminate red tape for businesses, and this will allow for freer movement of workers in the trades and working across boundaries. Also, businesses can bid on work in different provinces."

To others, the CFTA sounds better in theory. Instead of having to depend on a list of approved trade items, everything is fair for export, unless there's a mention of it in the exceptions list. But in all the hype about how great this agreement is, no one mentions the fact that there are 160 pages of exceptions!